The Mughal Empire

BABUR (1526-1530)

- Babur was the **founder of the Mughal Empire in India.** Babur succeeded his father Umar Shaikh Mirza as the ruler of Farghana.
- Babur took interest in conquering India and launched four expeditions between 1519 and 1523.

MILITARY CONQUESTS

- On the eve of Babur's invasion of India, there were five prominent Muslim rulers – the Sultans of Delhi, Gujarat, Malwa, Bengal and the Deccan – and two prominent Hindu rulers – Rana Sangha of Mewar and the Vijayanagar Empire.
- On 21st April 1526 the **first Battle of Panipat** took place between **Babur and Ibrahim Lodi, who was killed in the battle.**
- Babur's success was due to his cavalry and artillery. Babur proclaimed himself as **"Emperor of Hindustan".**
- Rana Sanga of Mewar marched against Babur and in the Battle of Khanwa (near Agra) held in 1527 Babur won a decisive victory over him. Babur assumed the title Ghazi.
- In 1528, Babur captured Chanderi from another Rajput ruler Medini Rai. In the next year,
  Babur defeated the Afghans in the Battle of Gogra in Bihar.

ESTIMATE OF BABUR

- He was also a great **scholar in Arabic and Persian languages**. Turki was his mother tongue. He wrote his memoirs, Tuzuk-i-Baburi in the Turki language.

HUMAYUN (1530-1540)

- Humayun was the eldest son of Babur. Humayun means "fortune" but he remained the most unfortunate ruler of the Mughal Empire.
- Humayun marched against Sher Khan and in the Battle of Chausa, held in 1539, Sher Khan destroyed the Mughal army and Humayun escaped from there.
- Humayun reached Agra to negotiate with his brothers. But as they were not cooperative, Humayun was forced to fight with Sher Khan alone in the Battle of

Bilgram in 1540. This battle was also known as the Battle of Kanauj. Humayun was thoroughly defeated by Sher Khan.

SUR INTERREGNUM (1540-1555)

- The founder of the **Sur dynasty was Sher Shah**.

SHER SHAH SUR (1540-1545)

- His empire consisted of the whole of North India except Assam, Nepal, Kashmir and Gujarat

SHER SHAH'S ADMINISTRATION

- The king was assisted by four important ministers.
  1. **Diwan –i- Wizarat –** also called as Wazir - in charge of Revenue and Finance.
  2. **Diwan-i-Ariz** – in charge of the Army.
  3. **Diwan-i-Risalat-** Foreign Minister.
  4. **Diwan-i-Insha-** Minister for Communications
- Sher Shah's empire was divided into forty seven sarkars. **Chief Shiqdar (law and order)** and **Chief Munsif (judge)** were the two officers in charge of the administration in each sarkar. Each sarkar was divided into several parganas.
- **Shiqdar (military officer**), **Amin (land revenue)**, **Fotedar (treasurer) Karkuns (accountants)** were in charge of the administration of each pargana. There were also many administrative units called iqtas.
- All cultivable lands were classified into three classes – good, middle and bad. The state's share was one third of the average produce and it was paid in cash or crop.
- Sher Shah introduced new silver coins called "Dam" and they were in circulation till 1835.
- Sher Shah had also improved communications by laying four important highways. They were: 1. Sonargaon to Sind 2. Agra to Burhanpur 3. Jodhpur to Chittor and 4. Lahore to Multan.
- Police were efficiently reorganized and crime was less during his regime.

ESTIMATE OF SHER SHAH

- Sher Shah remained a pious Muslim and generally **tolerant towards other religions.**
- He built a new city on the banks of the river Yamuna near Delhi. He also built a

Mausoleum at Sasaram, which is considered as one of the masterpieces of Indian architecture.

- **Malik Muhammad Jayasi wrote the famous Hindi work Padmavat during his reign.**

HUMAYUN (1555-1556)

- When Humayun left India in 1540, he married Hamida Banu Begum on his way to Sind. When they stayed in Amarkot, a Hindu kingdom ruled by Rana Prasad, Akbar was born in 1542.
- In 1555, Humayun defeated the Afghans and recovered the Mughal throne.
- He was a student of mathematics, astronomy and astrology. He also loved painting and wrote poetry in Persian language.

AKBAR (1556-1605)

- Akbar was one of the greatest monarchs of India.
- In the second Battle of Panipat in 1556, Hemu(Commander-in-chief of Afghanistan) was almost on the point of victory. But an arrow pierced his eye and he became unconscious. His army fled and the fortune favoured Akbar. The Mughal victory was decisive.
- He conquered northern India from Agra to Gujarat and then from Agra to Bengal. He strengthened the northwest frontier.

RELATIONS WITH RAJPUTS

- He married the Rajput princess, the daughter of Raja Bharamal. It was a turning point in the history of Mughals. Raja Bhagawan Das and Raja Man Singh were given senior positions in the administration by Akbar.
- But the Ranas of Mewar continued to defy despite several defeats. In the Battle of Haldighati, Rana Pratap Singh was severely defeated by the Mughal army led by Man Singh in 1576.
- **He abolished the pilgrim tax and later the jizya.**
- The Rajput policy of Akbar proved to be beneficial to the Mughal state as well as to the Rajputs.

RELIGIOUS POLICY

- In the beginning of his life, Akbar was a pious Muslim. Soon after marrying Jodh Bai of Amber, he abolished the pilgrim tax and in 1562, **he abolished jizya.** He allowed his Hindu wives to worship their own gods.
- In 1575, he ordered for the **construction of Ibadat Khana (House of worship**) at his new capital Fatepur Sikri.
- He **disliked the interference of the Muslim Ulemas in political matters**. In 1579, he issued the "Infallibility Decree" by which he asserted his religious powers.
- In 1582, he promulgated a **new religion called Din Ilahi or Divine Faith**. It believes in **one God**. It contained good points of all religions. Its basis was rational. However, his new faith proved to be a failure.

LAND REVENUE ADMINISTRATION

- Akbar made some experiments in the land revenue administration with the help of Raja Todar Mal. The land revenue system of Akbar was called **Zabti or Bandobast system**. It was known as **Dahsala System** which was completed in 1580.
- By this system, Todar Mal introduced a uniform system of land measurement. The revenue was fixed on the average yield of land assessed on the basis of the past ten years.
- The land was also divided into four categories – Polaj (cultivated every year), Parauti (once in two years), Chachar (once in three or four years) and Banjar (once in five or more years). Payment of revenue was made generally in cash.

MANSABDARI SYSTEM

- **Akbar introduced the Mansabdari system in his administration**. Under this system every officer was assigned a rank (mansab).
- The lowest rank was 10 and the highest was 5000 for the nobles.The ranks were divided into two – zat and sawar. Zat means personal and it fixed the personal status of a person. Sawar rank indicated the number of cavalrymen of a person who was required to maintain
- Every sawar had to maintain at least two horses. The mansab rank was not hereditary. All appointments and promotions as well as dismissals were directly made by the emperor.

JAHANGIR (1605-1627)

- When Akbar died, Prince Salim succeeded with the title Jahangir (Conqueror of World) in **1605**. His son Khusrau revolted but was defeated and imprisoned. **One of his supporters, Guru Arjun, the fifth Sikh Guru, was beheaded.**

NUR JAHAN

- In 1611, Jahangir married Mehrunnisa who was known as Nur Jahan (Light of World).
- In 1612, Asaf Khan's daughter, Arjumand Banu Begum (later known as Mumtaj), married Jahangir's third son, prince Khurram (later Shah Jahan).
- It was believed by some historians that Nur Jahan formed a group of "junta" and this led to two factions in the Mughal court. She encouraged Persian art and culture in the court.

SHAH JAHAN (1627-1658)

- Shah Jahan carved four Mughal provinces in the Deccan – Khandesh, Berar, Telungana and Daulatabad. They were put under the control of his son Aurangazeb.

WAR OF SUCCESSION

- The last years of Shah Jahan's reign were clouded by a bitter war of succession among his four sons – Dara Shikoh (crown prince), Shuja (governor of Bengal), Aurangazeb (governor of Deccan) and Murad Baksh (governor of Malwa and Gujarat).
- Shah Jahan lived for eight long years lovingly nursed by his daughter Jahanara. He died in 1666 and was buried beside his wife's grave in the Taj Mahal.

AURANGAZEB (1658-1707)

- Aurangazeb was one of the ablest of the Mughal kings. He assumed the title Alamgir, World Conqueror.

DECCAN POLICY

- The Deccan policy of the Mughals started from the reign of Akbar, who conquered Khandesh and Berar. Jahangir fought against Malik Amber of Ahmednagar. During the Shah Jahan's reign, Aurangazeb, as governor of Deccan, followed an aggressive Deccan policy.

- To contain the spread of the Marathas, Aurangazeb decided to invade Bijapur and Golconda. He defeated Sikandar Shah of Bijapur and annexed his kingdom. Then, he proceeded against Golkonda and eliminated the **Qutb Shahi dynasty.**
- His Deccan campaigns exhausted the Mughal treasury.

RELIGIOUS POLICY

- Aurangazeb was a staunch and orthodox Muslim in his personal life. His ideal was to transform India into an Islamic state. He created a separate department to enforce moral codes under a high-powered officer called Muhtasib. Drinking was prohibited.
- Cultivation and use of bhang and other drugs were banned.
- **Aurangazeb forbade music in the Mughal court.** He discontinued the practice of Jharokha Darshan. He also discontinued the celebration of Dasara and royal astronomers and astrologers were also dismissed from service.
- Initially Aurangazeb banned the construction of new Hindu temples and repair of old temples. Then he began a policy of destroying Hindu temples. The celebrated temples at Mathura and Benares were reduced to ruins. In 1679, **he reimposed jizya and pilgrim tax.**
- The celebration of Muharram was stopped. His invasions against the Deccan sultanates were partly due to his hatred of the Shia faith.
- **He was also against the Sikhs and he executed the ninth Sikh Guru Tej Bahadur.**
- **His religious policy was responsible for turning the Rajputs, the Marathas and Sikhs into the enemies of Mughal empire**. It had also resulted in the rebellions of the Jats of Mathura and the Satnamis of Mewar. Therefore, Aurangazeb was held responsible for the decline of the Mughal empire.

Akbar

- Agra Fort- built in red sandstone
- Akbar also built a palacecum-fort complex at Fatehpur Sikri (City of Victory).
- The most magnificent building in it-
    - Jama Masjid
    - Gateway to it is called Buland Darwaza or the Lofty Gate. Built to commemorate Akbar's victory over Gujarat
    - Jodh Bai's palace and Panch Mahal with five storeys
- During Akbar's reign, the Humayun's tomb was built in Delhi and it has a massive dome of marble
- It may be considered as the precursor of Taj Mahal
- Akbar's tomb at Sikandara near Agra was completed by Jahangir
- Nur Jahan built the tomb of Itimaddaulah at Agra. It was constructed wholly out of white marble with floral designs made of semi-precious stones on the walls. This type of decoration was called pietra dura
- This method became more popular during the reign of Shah Jahan
- Taj Mahal is considered a jewel of the builder's art
- Mosque building had reached its peak during Shah Jahan's reign
- The Moti Masjid at Agra was built entirely in white marble
- The Jama Masjid at Delhi, was built in red sandstone

ProdEgyIAS
DEMOCRATIZING EDUCATION

Paintings and music

- The foundation for the Mughal painting was laid by Humayun
- He brought with him two painters- Mir Sayyid Ali and Abdal Samad to India. These two painters became famous during Akbar's reign
- Akbar invited a large number of painters from different parts of the country to his court. Both Hindus and Muslims joined
- Akbar's court artists- Baswan, Miskina and Daswant
- Illustrations of Persian versions of Mahabharata and Ramayana were produced in miniature form
- Akbar Nama also remained the main theme of Mughal paintings. The most important work is Hamzanama, which consisted 1200 paintings
- Colors used- peacock blue, Indian red
- Mughal paintings reached its climax during the reign of Jahangir. He employed a number of painters like Abul Hasan, Bishan Das, Madhu, Anant, Manohar, Govardhan and Ustad Mansur

- Apart from paintings, the scenes of hunting, battles and royal courts, progress was made in portrait paintings and paintings of animals

Music developed under the Mughals

- Akbar patronized Tansen of Gwalior
- Tansen composed many ragas
- Jahangir and Shah Jahan were also fond of music

Language and literature

- Persian language became widespread in the Mughal empire by the time of Akbar's reign
- Abul Fazl was a great scholar and historian who set a style of prose writing
- He wrote Ain-i-Akbari and Akbarnama
- Abul Faizi- the leading poet of that period who was his brother. The translation of Mahabharata into the Persian language was done under his supervision
- Utbi and Naziri were two other leading Persian poets
- Jahangir's autobiography was- Tuzuk-i-Jahangiri
- Shah Jahan also patronized many writers and historians like
    - Abdul Hamid Lahori, author of Padshahnama
    - Inayat Khan, author of Shah Jahan Nama
- His son Dara Shikoh translated the Bhagavad Gita and Upanishads into Persian language
- Regional languages such as Bengali, Odia, Rajasthani and Gujarati had also developed during this period
- Many devotional works including the Ramayana and Mahabharata were translated into regional languages
- From the time of Akbar, Hindi poets were attached to the Mughal court
- The most influential Hindi poet was Tulsidas, who wrote the Hindi version of the Ramayana, the Ramacharitamanas

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